

MN MOHR Conference



*Supporting Day Services Staff to Increase Community Life
Engagement Outcomes and a Pathway to Employment*

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Sherry Healey, Institute on Community Integration, University of Minnesota
Heale041@umn.edu

Staci Jones, Institute for Community Inclusion, University of Massachusetts at Boston
Staci.Jones@umb.edu

Today's Agenda

- About Minnesota Transformation Initiative (MTI)
- Brief History of Disability Services
 - Lessons Learned
- New Models of Support
- Best Practices in Employment and Day Services
 - About Community Life Engagement
- Holistic Organizational Transformation
- Questions



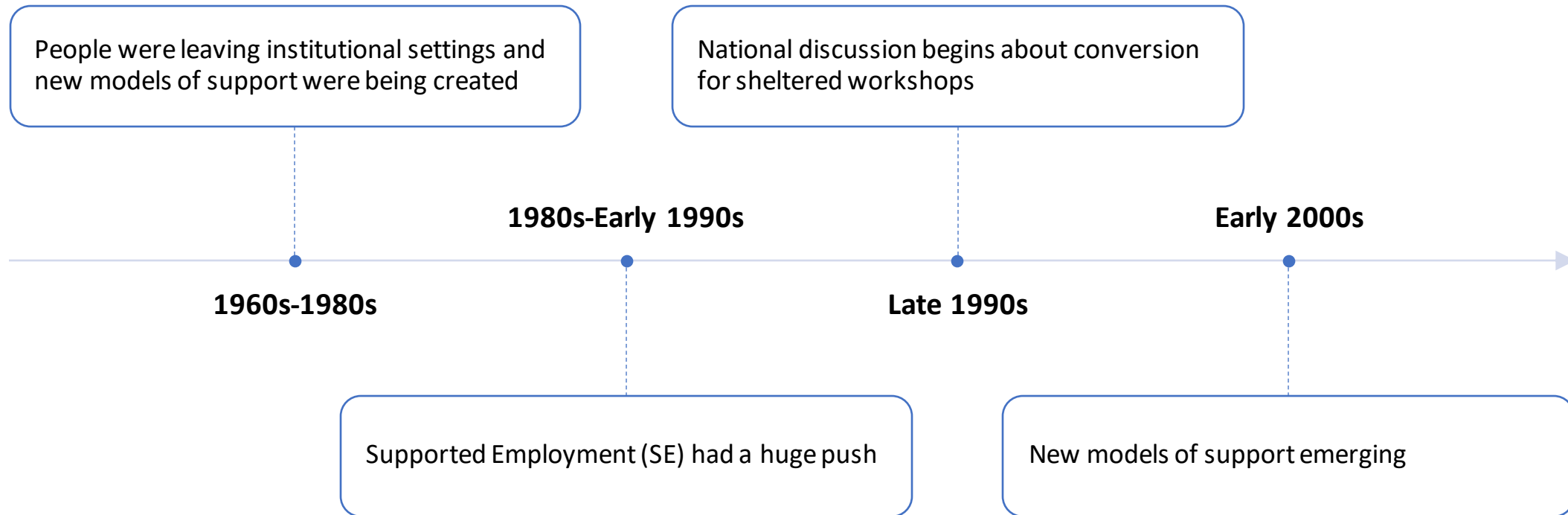
MTI Landing Page:
<https://mti.ici.umn.edu/>

Who is here today?

- Day Services Direct Support Staff?
- Day Services Managers?
- Employment Staff/Managers?
- Residential Staff/Managers?
- Case Managers?
- Others?



How did we get here?



How did we get here?

10-15 years of converging national transformation initiatives

- Centers for Medicare and Medicaid (CMS) [Informational Bulletin on Employment and Final Settings Rule](#)
- **Administered by MN DHS**
- Employment First initiative
- **MN Employment First Policy & E1 MN**
- Workforce Innovation and Opportunity Act (WIOA)
- **MN CareerForce Centers & VRS**
- Olmstead Act
- **Olmstead Court Settlement in MN**
- States phasing out 14c certificate use
- **Minnesota Subminimum Taskforce**



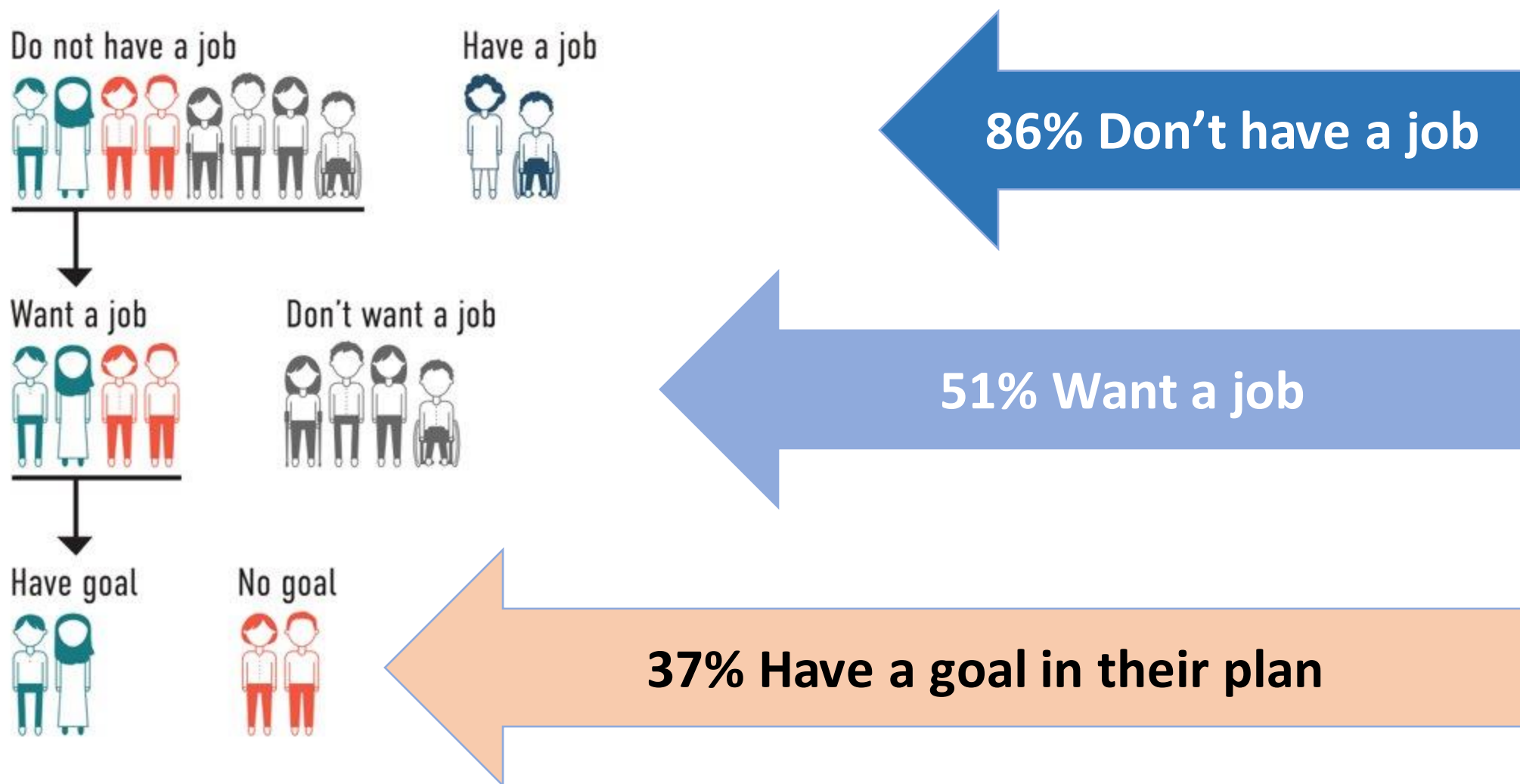
What is Employment First?

- A movement
- A National and State-level framework of systems change
- A set of values

“Employment in the general workforce is the first and preferred outcome in the provision of publicly funded services for all working age citizens with disabilities, regardless of level of disability” [\(APSE\)](#)



What does the Data say?



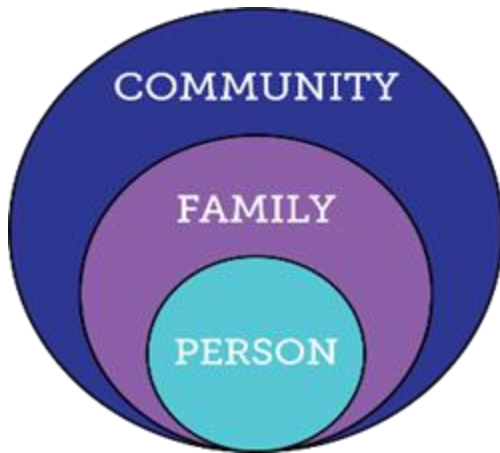
Why Employment First?

It is *critical* to keep in mind history of people with disabilities:

Lessons Learned

The 'readiness model' doesn't work

Shifting Service Models



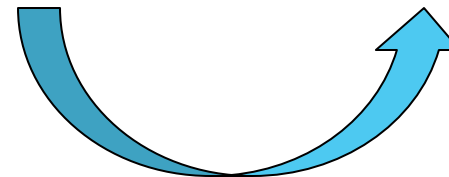
Everyone exists within
the context of family and
community



Traditional
Disability Services



Integrated Services and
Supports within context of
person, family and community



From lifecoursetools.com © UMKC Institute for Human Development

How have services evolved?

Individualized services (NOT programs)

Outcome based vs. attendance based

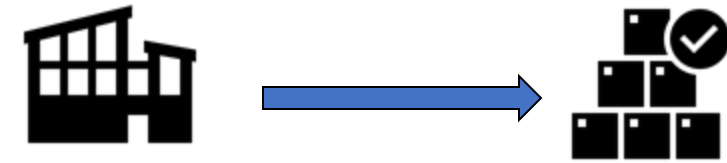
Ability to access multiple services, flexible schedules

Services are ONE part of a person's support system

Providers are connectors, not program builders

Supporting the achievement of desired outcomes *today*

CIE is an expected outcome for people of working age NOW, regardless of level of support needed



This requires a service system that is fundamentally different

Employment: Active, Individualized Job Placement Process

Competitive Integrated Employment is prioritized

Community-based discovery and customization

Use personal networks

Work directly with local employers to develop and customize

Work one person at a time

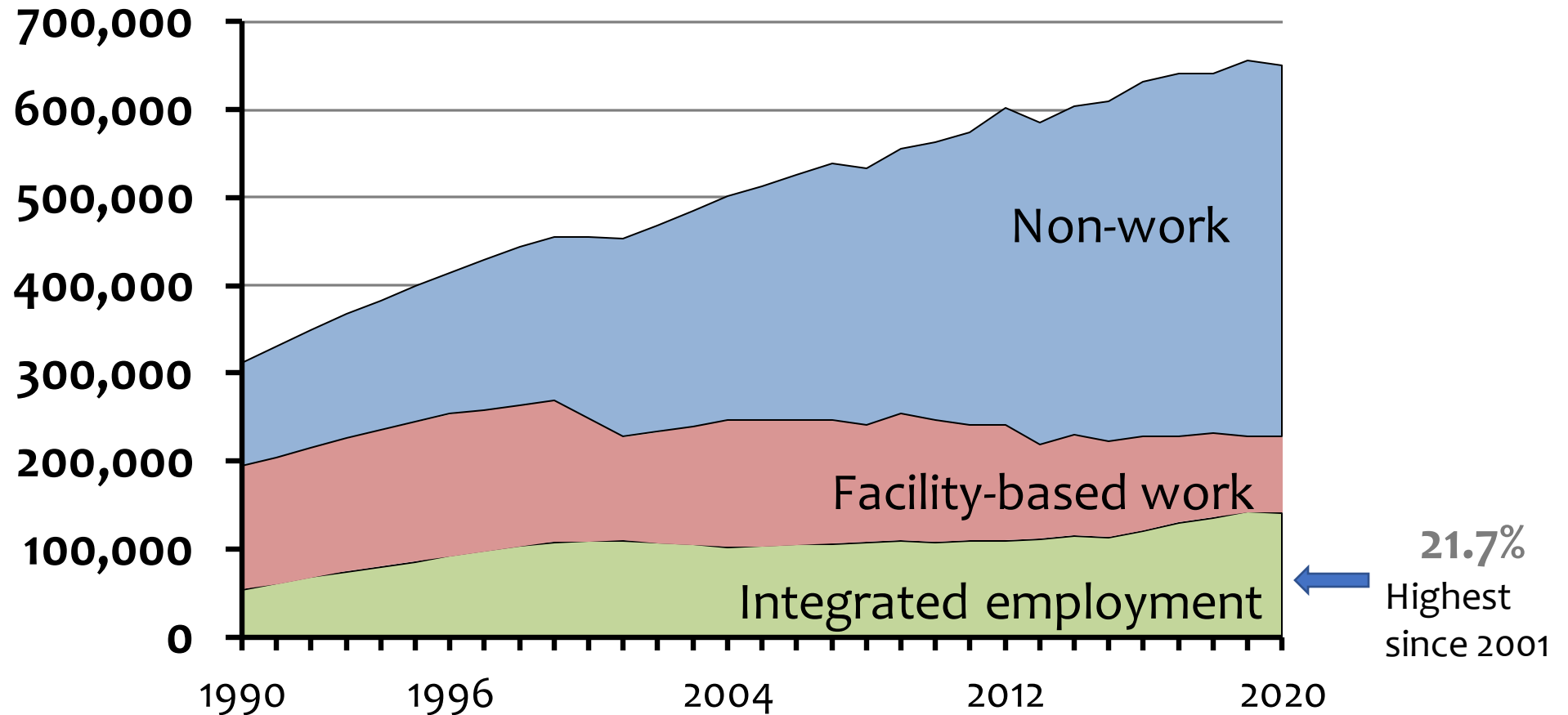


Employment is Everyone's Job

We can, and should, support people wherever they are on their path to employment, ***no matter what service the person receives***



Numbers in Employment and Day Services



https://www.statedata.info/sites/statedata.info/files/files/bluebook_2022_complete_F.pdf

Values and Best Practices of Quality Day Services



- A belief that people with IDD can fully participate in typical valued social roles, including competitive integrated employment
- Using generic, typical resources available to all
- Occur in typical community settings, in small groups (no more than 3-4)
- View staff role as facilitators of inclusion
- Avoiding activities that reinforce stereotypes and stigma
- Avoiding activities that unnecessarily segregate
- Supports the development of self-advocacy skills
- Support a path to employment (Employment First values)
- **Support outcomes of *community life engagement (CLE)***

Day Services: Supporting Community Life Engagement (CLE)

All the ways that people with IDD access and participate in their communities, outside of employment, as part of a meaningful day.

- Non-work
- Accessing typical community facilities (library, gym, rec center, etc.)
- Volunteerism
- Post-secondary &/or continuing education
- Wrap-around to work
- Pathway to work
- Retirement activities





Quality Day Services that Support CLE Outcomes

What they are *not*:

- A substitute for paid employment
- A prerequisite for employment
- Activities just to fill time
- Activities that individuals are “plugged” into
- Random activities just to keep people busy

The 4 Guideposts of CLE



Community Life Engagement
INSTITUTE FOR COMMUNITY INCLUSION, UMASS BOSTON

~Came from case studies and expert interviews

~Became a set of key principles (guideposts) providers can use to move their CLE efforts forward

Guidepost 1: Individualized supports for each person

Guidepost 2: Promote community membership and contribution

[CLE TOOLKIT - CLE-Toolkit
\(communityinclusion.org\)](https://communityinclusion.org)

Guidepost 3: Facilitate relationships and skill building to decrease dependence on paid supports

Guidepost 4: Ensure supports are outcome-oriented and regularly monitored

Community Life Engagement Fidelity Scale

- Use as a self- assessment tool
- Completed by staff and management
- Answer based on how your day services are currently structured

https://www.communityinclusion.org/files/cle-toolkit/guideposts_assessment.pdf

Community Life Engagement Fidelity Scale[®]

January 2023

This fidelity scale is designed to help providers of day services for individuals with intellectual and developmental disabilities (IDD) determine their strengths and areas for improvement in supporting individuals' community life engagement. Community life engagement refers to access and participation in the community through inclusive non-work activities such as volunteer work, continuing education, and recreation. For more on CLE and the research behind this scale see: <https://www.thinkwork.org/cle>

This fidelity scale should be completed by staff and management who have a familiarity with the day services and supports offered by the provider.

Please respond to the following statements based upon how your [non-work] day services and supports are currently structured.

For each section, add up the numbers you circled for each response to see where you fall in the range.

Part 1: Organizational Values

Please circle how much you agree the following statements apply to your organization.

My organization...	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither Disagree nor Agree	Agree	Strongly Agree	Enter Number Here
Makes sure all working-age individuals have opportunities to explore employment	1	2	3	4	5	_____
Ensures families are aware of the organization's emphasis on individualized, person-centered, community-based supports	1	2	3	4	5	_____
Ensures all staff are aware of the organization's emphasis on individualized, person-centered, community-based supports	1	2	3	4	5	_____
Total for Part 1	Score Range 3-6 = Low 7-11 = Medium 12-15 = High <i>For more about Organizational Values, visit Community Life Engagement Toolkit, Guidepost 4.</i>					_____

CLE Guidepost #1: Individualized Supports for Each Person



- Starts with understanding personal preferences, goals, interests and skills
- Emphasizes person-centered planning and discovery, and
- Requires creative staffing, intentional grouping, and at times additional funding (not always 1:1 support)

Day Service Provider Strategies Guidepost #1

Get to know people *differently*:

- Supporting people to explore and continually get new experiences in typical community settings
- Help identify who the person is now and as they evolve
- Identify who is important in the person's life (*is it mostly paid staff and people with disabilities?*)
- Identify skills/abilities
- Identify interests, likes/dislikes
- ***Fold the information we learn back into service delivery***



DSP Tools and Strategies: Guidepost #1

Provide tools for staff:

- Relationship maps
- Important to/for
- Positive personal profiles

Model how to use the tools and the info learned:

- Example- How do you know what skills a person has?
- Example- When we learn contradictory info about someone, what might it tell us?
- Example- What/how are people communicating through their behavior?



<https://www.transcen.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/03/Positive-Personal-Profile-Example.pdf>

Poll Question #1

(from fidelity scale)



My organization provides training to staff in person-centered planning and/or thinking approaches?

1 Strongly Disagree

2 Disagree

3 Neither Disagree nor Agree

4 Agree

5 Strongly Agree

CLE Guidepost #2: Promote Community Membership & Contribution



- Start with inclusive settings and activities
- Ensure staff presence does not limit connections with community
- Of community vs in the community
- Consider the person and their unique preferences and goals

Day Service Provider Strategies Guidepost #2

About inclusive settings:

- The same places that people without disabilities are spending their time
- Provides exposure for people with ***and without*** disabilities
- Opportunities to interact with others without disabilities and paid staff
- **Note: This may require community outreach and education**



Day Service Provider Strategies Guidepost #2

Of the community vs. In the community:

- Physical presence **does not** equal inclusion
- Facilitate meaningful contribution
- Relationships are built through routine participation
 - **not** a string of ever-changing activities
- Help people re-connect with their existing networks?
- People's home communities may be different...



In the Community	Of the Community
Dwayne listens to music at a local concert, during day program hours.	Dwayne is introduced to his church's choir director and becomes a member of the choir.
Dwayne visits the library with a group of 10 and staff check out books on behalf of people.	Dwayne visits library with 2 others and support staff introduces him to the librarian at the circulation desk to learn about library services and the librarian supports Dwayne to get a library card and explains how to use it. Staff stands back and only provides support if needed.
Dwayne sits in the park and listens to music.	Dwayne is supported to attend his local neighborhood block party. Staff can facilitate introductions with neighbors.



- Nothing inherently wrong here, just may not lead to membership
- Typically, 'one and done'
- Harder to build natural connections



- Provides opportunity to meet people with mutual or shared interests
- More opportunity for organic relationship building and widening of social networks

DSP Tools and Strategies: Guidepost #2

Change how you hire and support staff:

- Community support vs. Caregivers
- This is a different skill set
- Requires ongoing staff mentoring
- Decentralized structure and community-based
- *How do you observe??*

Change how you train staff:

- Person Centered Thinking and Planning
- Community navigation and mapping
- Avoid 'learned dependence'
- Staff 'do with' instead of 'do for'
- Staff can model for community members



Poll Question #2



My organization provides training to staff on how to identify and build natural supports (in non-work service)

1 Strongly Disagree

2 Disagree

3 Neither Disagree nor Agree

4 Agree

5 Strongly Agree

This infographic features a central dark blue silhouette of a person. Radiating from this center are ten lines, each connecting to a different icon that represents a key area of life. Starting from the top and moving clockwise, the icons are: a yellow lightbulb (ideas/education), a yellow megaphone (communication), a grey head with gears (thought/learning), a blue Wi-Fi symbol (technology), a blue pill bottle (healthcare), a grey group of people (community), a yellow house (home/family), a blue handshake (work/business), a green alarm clock (time/sleep), and a blue stethoscope (healthcare). The entire composition is set against a teal background with a pattern of white dots in the upper left corner.

Provider Strategies Guidepost #3

Relationships:

- Decrease dependence on only paid support in a person's life when possible
- Facilitate development of relationships with other people
- Accessing the value inherent in a **network of relationships**

Skills:

- Successfully repeated tasks increase confidence
- What can lead to more independence for a particular person?

Examples:

- Accessing public transportation
- Using a cell phone
- Making choices
- Making purchases



DSP Tools and Strategies: Guidepost #3

- Create a dedicated position to community building and development (DSPs can't do it all!)
- Create regular schedules that are person-centered and built **with** the person and adjusted as needed
- Reduce reliance on center-based activities
- Work with DSPs to infuse skill building into daily and weekly schedules

Examples:

- Getting lost on purpose
- Use of technology
- How to navigate community spaces
- Accessing public transportation
- Interaction with community members



Poll Question #3

(from fidelity scale)



My organization supports individuals to form friendships with people outside the IDD system?

1 Strongly Disagree

2 Disagree

3 Neither Disagree nor Agree

4 Agree

5 Strongly Agree

CLE Guidepost #4: Outcome-oriented and Regularly Monitored



- Emphasize goals and clear expectations
- Expect CLE to lead to or complement employment
- Use data for quality improvement

Provider Strategies Guidepost #4

- What are the goals you are helping someone achieve?
- What data are you tracking?
 - Is it measurable? (hours, frequency, skill learned, etc.)
- Employment First values baked into service delivery, with competitive integrated employment the expected outcome for people of working age



DSP Tools and Strategies: Guidepost #4

Starting the conversation- shifting the focus to employment

- Imagine yourself working. What would you be doing?
- What's the best that can happen if you get a job?
- What worries you about getting a job?
- If you had more money, how would you I

Focusing on the Destination- Identify interests and develop a plan

- What are your favorite things to do?
- How do you spend your day?
- What do you like best/least about your day?
- Tell me about things you do NOT like to do

Career Success- Maintain focus on career growth

- What is the best part of your job?
- What do you do at work that makes you feel proud?
- How do you get along with your co-workers?

<https://www.selnhub.org/guidanceforconversations>



Poll Question #4

(from fidelity scale)



My organization makes sure all working-age individuals have opportunities to explore employment?

1 Strongly Disagree

2 Disagree

3 Neither Disagree nor Agree

4 Agree

5 Strongly Agree

How does it happen?

- ***Provider Transformation*** that leads to improved CIE and CLE outcomes
 - Intentional and strategic redesign of an organization
- No one gets left behind! We need everyone for transformation

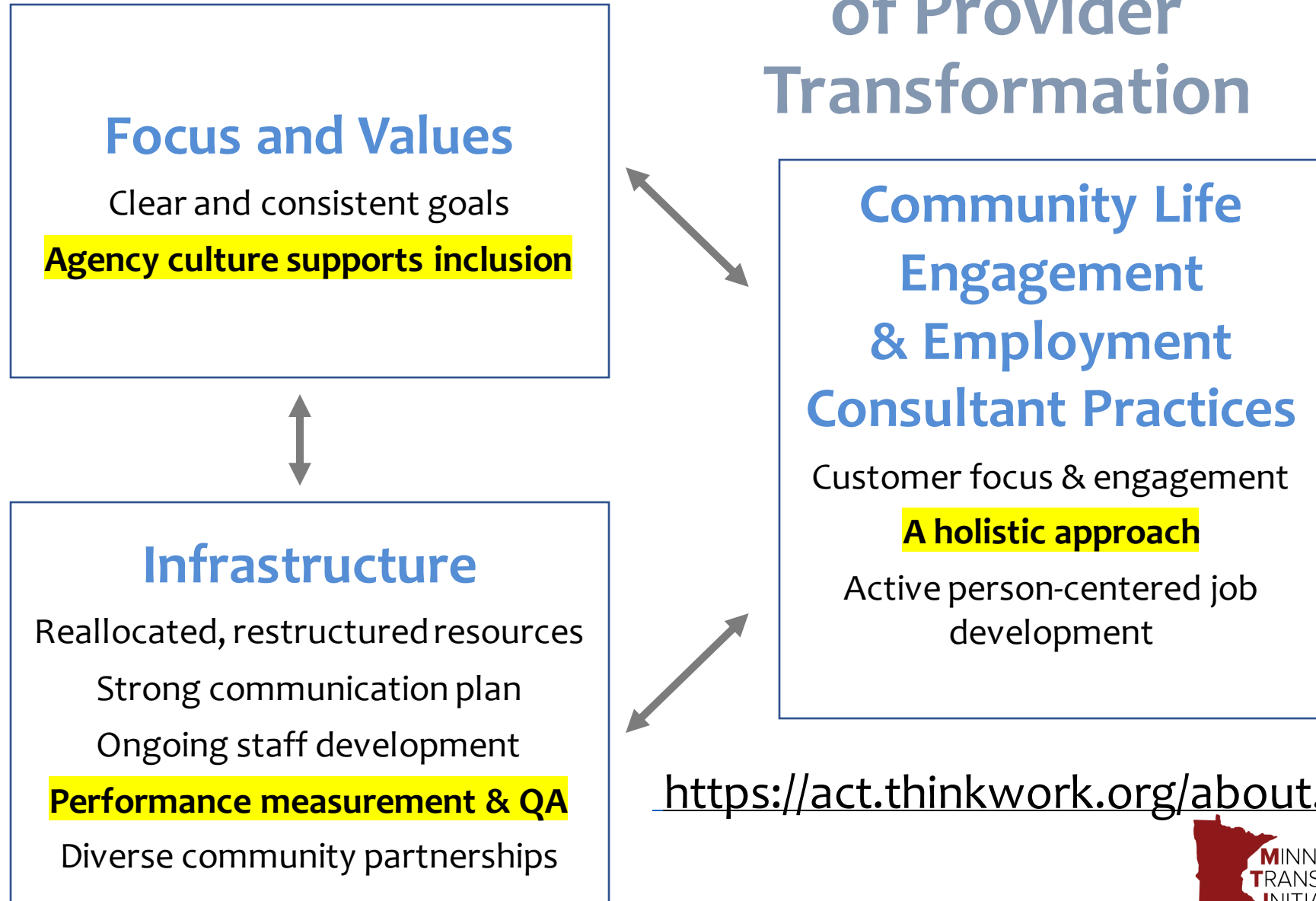


Research from University of Massachusetts at Boston (ICI Umass):

10 Essential Elements of Organizational Transformation

<https://act.thinkwork.org/about.html>

10 Essential Elements of Provider Transformation



<https://act.thinkwork.org/about.html>

Agency culture supports inclusion

“Culture eats strategy for breakfast.”

Your organization translates values into action:

- Employment and community are prioritized and celebrated!
- Everyone is working together to align your environment and services with a new way of thinking
- All leaders (regardless of role) ensure that policy and practice ***match*** agency core values
- Value ongoing learning & skill development
- Celebrate creativity & innovation
- Become flexible and resilient
- Engage in continuous quality improvement



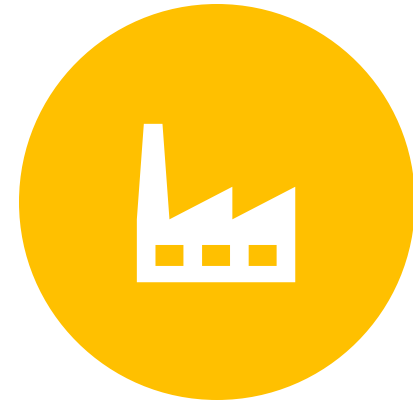
Use a Holistic Approach



CONSIDER A PERSON'S WHOLE LIFE
WHEN PLANNING



MAXIMIZE COMMUNITY LIFE
ENGAGEMENT OPPORTUNITIES



MAKE EMPLOYMENT EVERYONE'S
BUSINESS-BREAK THE SILOS!!!



- Is each department working toward and/or supporting common goals?
- Does each department understand how they support CIE & CLE outcomes?
- Are there inefficiencies and/or duplications of effort?
- Are there gaps in communication (multi-directional)?
- Are processes integrated across teams, people, departments?

**Use a
Holistic
Approach**

Performance Measurement and Quality Assurance

- As a Manager (and as an organization), how are you defining and measuring success?
- What weekly/monthly/annual metrics should you be tracking?
 - Hours spent in integrated settings?
 - Volunteerism opportunities?
 - Skills developed?
 - Community connections/partners created?
- How will you evaluate staff performance?
 - Based on outcomes supported?
 - Surveying people in services?
 - Observation?
 - Other?



St. John's Community Services



What Drives Us

At the heart of our services and programs is our mission: advancing inclusive communities where every person, regardless of circumstances, has the right and opportunity to live their best life.

https://cletoolkit.communityinclusion.org/additional-resources/st_johns_conversion



Questions?

Session Evaluation

